

HARSHA ARAVIND

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EDUCATION

Master of Arts, Economics, University of Toronto June 2026
Department of Economics

- **CGPA:** 3.71/4.0
- **Relevant Courses:** Microeconomics (A+), Econometrics (A-), Research Paper (A)
 - "Do Consumers Remember Yesterdays Prices? Adding (non-linear) Price Reference Effects to the BLP Model"

Bachelor of Science - High Distinction, University of Toronto Oct 2025
Specialization in Economics & Mathematics

- **CGPA:** 3.5/4.0
- **Relevant Courses:** Empirical Applications of Economic Theory (A-), Applied Econometrics II (A), Advanced Calculus (A-), Linear Algebra II (A+), Nonlinear Optimization (A+)

CERTIFICATES

The Structured Query Language (SQL) - University of Colorado Boulder (Coursera) July 2026
Introduction to Python for Researchers - Imperial College London (Coursera) June 2026
TCPS 2: CORE-2022 (Course on Research Ethics) - Panel on Research Ethics Jan 2023

EXPERIENCE

University of Northern British Columbia Dec 2022 - May 2026
Research Assistant, Department of Economics

- Collected and sorted data for a project aiming to understand the effects of collective property ownership on First Nations economic development in Canada
 - Sorted, categorized, and downloaded Canadian Census variables and data using the Canadian Census Analyzer (CHASS; database of Canadian Censuses)
 - Used Excel to transcribe financial records made available from the First Nations Financial Transparency Act (FNFTA) into a single document

University of Toronto Sept 2025 - May 2026
Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics

- Course: *Introduction to Data Analysis and Applied Econometrics* (ECO220Y1) for the 2025-2026 academic year
- Held weekly office hours; helped students understand the statistical tools used in economic analysis
- Invigilated and marked term tests and a final exam for a class of over 450 students

The Exploration Place May 2023 - Aug 2023
Curatorial Assistant (Seasonal)

Elections BC Oct 2020
Secondary School Student Election Official

RELEVANT ACADEMIC PROJECTS

- Do Consumers Remember Yesterdays Prices? Adding (non-linear) Price Reference Effects to the BLP Model
 - MA Course: Research Paper, Winter 2026
 - Implemented logit, nested logit and BLP models to measure the effects of "sticker shock" and "bargain hunting" on consumer demand
 - Used Python (Pandas, NumPy and PyBLP packages) for data processing and empirical analysis
- Applications of Quantile Regression: The Effects of Child Tax Benefits
 - MA Course: Econometrics, Fall 2025

- Investigated the effects of Canadian child tax benefits across different quantiles of child outcomes
- Implemented regression trees in R (rpart, randomForest, gbm, and BART packages)
- Labour Misallocation in the Ugandan Agricultural Sector
 - Joint PhD & MA Course: Growth and Development, Fall 2025
 - Found that labour reallocation could generate large efficiency gains in the Ugandan agricultural sector
 - Estimated the parameters of a macroeconomic production model using generalized method of moments (GMM) in R

PERSONAL

Technical Skills: Python (NumPy, Pandas, PyBLP), R (AER, ggplot2, neuralnet), SQL (PostgreSQL), Stata, Excel

Interests: Data analysis, applied econometrics, mathematics

Favourite Book(s): A tie between *Catch-22* and *Breakfast of Champions*

Hobbies: Playing piano and drums; reading